

ADA / WCAG 2.1 Compliance Audit

City of Colorado Springs — 2C Road Improvements Page

Page: 2C Road Improvements | City of Colorado Springs

URL: <https://coloradosprings.gov/2C>

Audit Date: May 13, 2026

Standard: WCAG 2.1 Level AA (required for ADA Title II compliance)

Auditor: Emma Moore, independent self-assessment

Executive Summary

The page demonstrates several accessibility best practices but contains a number of issues that would prevent full WCAG 2.1 AA conformance. Issues range from **Critical** (likely to block assistive technology users completely) to **Minor** (best-practice improvements). A total of **14 distinct issues** were identified across **7 WCAG success criteria**.

Severity	Count
Critical	2
High	5
Medium	4
Low / Best practice	3
Total findings	14

What the Page Does Well

- **Page language declared.** The `<html>` element correctly sets `lang="en"` and `dir="ltr"`, enabling screen readers to use the correct language engine.
- **Page title is descriptive.** "2C Road Improvements | City of Colorado Springs" clearly identifies both the page topic and the site.
- **Skip navigation link present.** A "Skip to main content" link exists and correctly targets `#main-content`, allowing keyboard users to bypass repetitive navigation.
- **Main landmark exists.** A `<main>` element is present, giving assistive technology a direct entry point into the primary content.
- **Breadcrumb navigation properly labeled.** The breadcrumb `<nav>` carries `aria-label="breadcrumb"` and is structured as an ordered list.
- **Accordion buttons use `aria-expanded` and `aria-controls`.** All 13 FAQ accordion buttons correctly signal their expanded/collapsed state and reference their controlled panel IDs.

- **Viewport allows zoom.** The meta viewport tag does not suppress user scaling, satisfying WCAG 1.4.4 (Resize Text).
- **Form inputs have associated labels.** The search form's text input and both dropdowns are properly labeled.
- **Body text color contrast likely sufficient.** Body text renders as `rgb(33, 37, 41)` on a white/light background, which meets AA contrast requirements.

Findings

CRITICAL

1. ArcGIS Paving Map iframe has no title attribute

Element: `<iframe src="https://experience.arcgis.com/experience/...">`

WCAG: 4.1.2 Name, Role, Value (Level A)

Impact: Screen reader users will encounter an unnamed embedded frame. JAWS and NVDA will announce "iframe" with no context, leaving users unable to understand the map's purpose.

Fix: Add `title="2C Proposed Paving Map"` to the iframe element.

2. Multiple links have no accessible name

WCAG: 2.4.4 Link Purpose (Level A), 4.1.2 Name, Role, Value (Level A)

Impact: Two home-logo links carry images with `alt="Home"` but no `aria-label`, producing duplicate "Home, link" announcements in the header. The GoCOS footer link relies on a descriptive image alt ("government building icon for GoCOS") as its accessible name, which is not appropriate as a link name.

Fix: Mark one of the duplicate home links as `aria-hidden="true"`. Add `aria-label="GoCOS — Report Online"` to the GoCOS footer link.

HIGH

3. PDF links open in new tab without warning users

Element: 11 paving list links (2016–2026)

WCAG: 2.4.4 Link Purpose (Level A), 3.2.2 On Input (Level A)

Impact: All paving list links open PDFs in a new tab via `target="_blank"` with no indication in link text, `aria-label`, or title that the file is a PDF or that it opens in a new window. The footer's DMCA and Privacy Policy links do include this treatment; the paving list links do not.

Fix: Update each link's text or `aria-label`, e.g. "2026 Paving List (PDF, opens in new tab)".

4. Duplicate heading text throughout the page

Element: 26 duplicate `<h3>` elements in the FAQ accordion

WCAG: 1.3.1 Info and Relationships (Level A)

Impact: Every FAQ section contains the same heading text twice — once for the accordion header, once for the expanded content panel. Screen reader users navigating by headings hear every FAQ question twice with no way to distinguish the toggle from the content. Likely a CMS template issue.

Fix: Remove the duplicate heading inside the expanded panel, or add a visually hidden suffix such as "(answer)".

5. FAQ headings use ALL CAPS text in HTML, not CSS

Element: Majority of FAQ `<h3>` elements

WCAG: 1.3.1 Info and Relationships (Level A), 3.1.5 Reading Level (advisory)

Impact: Uppercase text is written directly in the HTML source. Screen readers such as VoiceOver may spell out all-caps text letter by letter rather than reading it as a sentence, making the questions difficult to understand aurally.

Fix: Use mixed case in HTML and apply text-transform: uppercase in CSS if the uppercase visual style is desired.

6. Banner carousel/slider controls lack descriptive labels

Element: Two "Previous/Next" and two "Play" links in the header

WCAG: 4.1.2 Name, Role, Value (Level A), 2.4.6 Headings and Labels (Level AA)

Impact: Carousel navigation links carry href="#" with no aria-label describing which slider they control or what action they perform. With two separate carousels in the header, assistive technology users cannot differentiate between them.

Fix: Add descriptive aria-label attributes, e.g. aria-label="Previous announcement", aria-label="Play weather slideshow".

7. 2C_Animation iframe title is not descriptive

Element: <iframe title="2C_Animation">

WCAG: 4.1.2 Name, Role, Value (Level A)

Impact: The embedded animation iframe uses a technical or file-name string rather than a human-readable description. Screen readers announce this literally, providing no meaningful context.

Fix: Change the title to title="Animated overview of the 2C Road Improvement program".

MEDIUM

8. Multiple navigation landmarks are not uniquely labeled

Element: 4 <nav> elements on the page

WCAG: 1.3.1 Info and Relationships (Level A)

Impact: Two of the four navigation landmarks rely on aria-labelledby by pointing to visually hidden titles, which may work but should be verified. When multiple navigation regions exist, each must be distinguishable.

Fix: Ensure every <nav> element has a unique, meaningful aria-label (e.g. "Main menu", "Quick links", "Footer") so screen reader landmark lists are navigable.

9. External links open in new tab without warning

Element: ArcGIS Story Map, Waze, City Code external library links

WCAG: 3.2.2 On Input (Level A)

Impact: Several external links open in a new browser tab via target="_blank" with no indication to the user, violating the principle of predictable navigation for screen reader and keyboard users.

Fix: Append visually hidden text (opens in new tab) or update aria-label for each external link.

10. Duplicate id attributes on accordion header elements

Element: 13 repeated sets of duplicate IDs, e.g. `id="accordion-header-946816"`

WCAG: 4.1.1 Parsing (Level A)

Impact: Duplicate IDs break ARIA relationships and cause unpredictable behavior with aria-labelledby associations in assistive technologies. Likely a CMS template bug rendering the same block twice per item.

Fix: Ensure each accordion header and panel ID is unique across the entire page.

11. Social media icon images in footer have no alt text

Element: Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, YouTube icons

WCAG: 1.1.1 Non-text Content (Level A)

Impact: Icons are rendered without `<img>` elements (likely CSS background images or icon fonts). Link text ("Facebook", etc.) does provide accessible names for the links themselves, lowering severity, but the icon images should still be accounted for.

Fix: If icon text already names the link, mark images as `aria-hidden="true"`. If icons carry independent meaning, they need alt text.

LOW / BEST PRACTICE

12. Search form's submit button label unverified

Element: `<input type="submit" id="edit-submit-search">`

WCAG: 4.1.2 Name, Role, Value (Level A)

Impact: The search submit input has no associated label, no aria-label, and no value attribute confirmed. While the visible DOM shows "Search", the input's programmatic name should be verified.

Fix: Add `aria-label="Submit search"` or ensure the button's value attribute is set to "Search".

13. Phone number link uses a non-standard href format

Element: `href="tel:%28719%29385-ROAD%287623%29"`

WCAG: 2.4.4 Link Purpose (Level A) — advisory

Impact: The phone number is URL-encoded with parentheses rather than the standard E.164 format. Some assistive technologies and mobile devices may not correctly parse this as a callable phone number.

Fix: Use `href="tel:+17193857623"` with display text "(719) 385-7623".

14. Orphaned "Upload File" text in article

Element: Generic element with text "Upload File" (ref_293)

WCAG: 1.3.1 Info and Relationships (Level A)

Impact: This orphaned text has no context or associated control and may confuse screen reader users. Appears to be a stray CMS artifact.

Fix: Investigate and remove the stray element, or hide it with `aria-hidden="true"` if it is non-functional.

Summary Table

#	Issue	WCAG Criterion	Severity
1	ArcGIS map iframe missing title	4.1.2	Critical
2	Links with no accessible name	2.4.4, 4.1.2	Critical
3	PDF links: no file-type or new-tab warning	2.4.4, 3.2.2	High
4	Duplicate heading text in accordions	1.3.1	High
5	FAQ headings in ALL CAPS HTML text	1.3.1	High
6	Carousel controls lack descriptive labels	4.1.2, 2.4.6	High
7	Animation iframe title not descriptive	4.1.2	High
8	Multiple nav landmarks not uniquely labeled	1.3.1	Medium
9	External links open new tab without warning	3.2.2	Medium
10	Duplicate id attributes on accordion headers	4.1.1	Medium
11	Social media icon images not accounted for	1.1.1	Medium
12	Search submit button label unverified	4.1.2	Low
13	Phone tel: link uses non-standard encoding	2.4.4	Low
14	Orphaned "Upload File" text in article	1.3.1	Low

Recommended Priority Order for Remediation

1. Add title to the ArcGIS map iframe (5-minute fix, high impact)
2. Fix all-caps heading text — switch to CSS text-transform (template-level change)
3. Update all paving list PDF links to announce file type and new-tab behavior
4. Add descriptive labels to all carousel navigation controls
5. Resolve duplicate heading/ID issue in the accordion CMS template
6. Uniquely label all <nav> landmark regions
7. Add new-tab warnings to all target="_blank" external links
8. Fix the animation iframe title to be human-readable
9. Correct the phone number href encoding
10. Investigate and remove or hide the orphaned "Upload File" element

Notes on Methodology

This audit is a self-assessment conducted by the author against the WCAG 2.1 Level AA standard, which is the conformance target referenced in the City of Colorado Springs Web Accessibility statement. Findings were identified through inspection of the published page source and accessibility tree. WCAG 2.1 criteria are cited by their published identifiers; success criterion 4.1.1 (Parsing) was retained in WCAG 2.1 Level A but removed in WCAG 2.2, and is included here because the City's stated conformance target is 2.1.

A formal third-party audit conducted by an IAAP-credentialed auditor (CPACC or WAS) or by an accessibility firm (Deque, Level Access, TPGi, Knowbility, or equivalent) is recommended prior to any binding conformance claim. This document is offered as a constructive starting point for the City's web team and Office of Accessibility.

Prepared by

Emma Moore

9805 Federal Drive, Colorado Springs, CO 80921

emma@pivotruenorth.com · emma@pvt.group · 310-913-8931

pivotruenorth.com · storyseedstudios.com · github.com/phonon56 · cheeto chopsticks.com